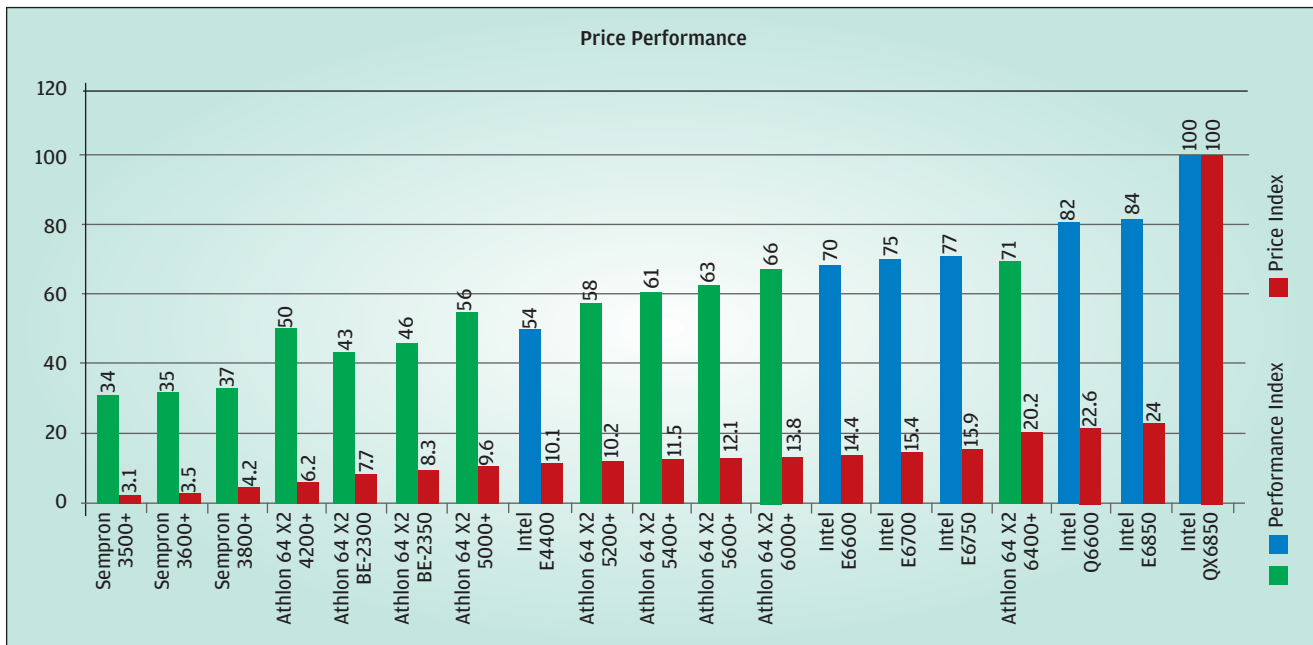
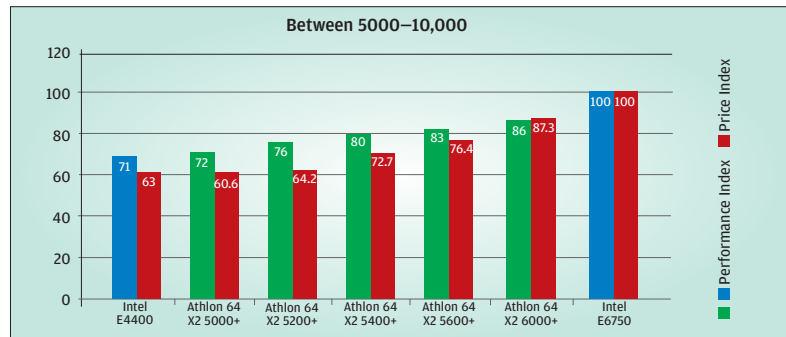




Under Rs 5,000

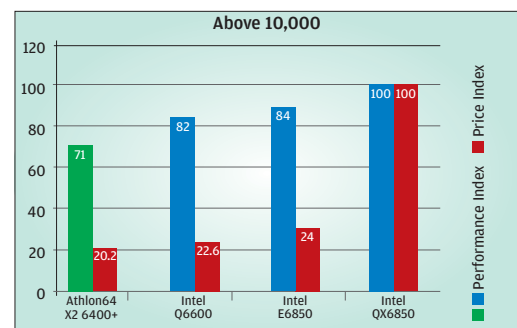
In the sub-5000 category, we find only AMD processors. It's quite clear that the Athlon64 X2 4200+ offers the best bang for the buck. Both the BE2350 and BE2300 offer relatively less performance, but with a TDP (Thermal Design Power) of 45W, they're aimed at power-conscious users.

Semprons, though good processors, should only be considered if you want the bare minimum configurations.



Rs 5,000-10,000

This is an important category—most of us end up buying processors in this range. The category is fairly large with a wide distribution, so we'll subdivide it into Rs 5,000-7,500 and Rs 7,500-10,000. In the Rs 5,000-7,500 category, AMD's Athlon64 X2 5000+ offers the maximum value, followed by the Athlon64 X2 5200+. In the Rs 7,500-10,000 bracket, Intel's E6750 offers good value for money and should be considered over all other processors in this category when building a gaming or entertainment system.



Over Rs 10,000

In this category, both the E6850 and Q6600 are equally good. The E6850 has a clear lead in single-threaded applications (which dominate our everyday lives), but on multi-threaded applications, the Q6600 trounces the E6850—it's the more future-proof option. The Athlon64 X2 6400+ does perform well, but on price / performance scale we won't recommend it. Intel's poster boy—the QX6850—is the ultimate number-cruncher money can buy today; if you have dough, go for it.

Of course, behind every good processor is a motherboard—read on to find the perfect match for your purchase.